Introduction to Philosophy Syllabus

Introduction to Philosophy, PHIL 1301-12487

Spring 2019, Online (3 Credit Hours)

HCC – Central College

HCC Online

No Scheduled Meeting Times

Instructor: Normand Theriault

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Office Hours: By Appointment Only

Course Description:

This course is a study of the major issues in philosophy and/or the work of major philosophical figures in philosophy. Topics in philosophy may include theories of reality, theories of knowledge, theories of value, and their practical applications (Texas ACGM). It provides a theoretically diverse introduction to the study of ideas, including arguments and investigations about abstract and real phenomena, particularly in the areas of knowledge, ethics, and religion (HCC Course Catalogue). This course stresses the HCC Core Objectives of Critical Thinking, Communication Skills, Personal Responsibility, and Social Responsibility.

PREREQUISITE(S):

- ENGL 1301 or higher

HCC CORE CURRICULUM:

This course satisfies the **Philosophy, Language, and Culture** component area or the **Component Area Option** in the HCC Core Curriculum. If you are not sure that you need this course to graduate, please consult with your advisor.

Course Goals:

My focus in this course is on reading, analyzing, and discussing original works by key figures in the history of philosophy. You will become a sharper thinker as a result of your studies in this course. Your writing will become more precise and your ideas clearer. You will gain a basic knowledge of philosophy and be able to apply that knowledge to other areas of life. And you will, despite the difficulty of the texts, enjoy arguing with your professor and fellow students about philosophy!

Student Learning Outcomes:

1. **Read**, **analyze**, and **critique** philosophical texts.

2. **Demonstrate knowledge** of key concepts, major arguments, problems, and terminology in philosophy.

3. **Present** logically persuasive arguments both orally and in writing.

4. **Demonstrate critical thinking skills** in evaluation and application of philosophical concepts to various aspects of life.

5. **Evaluate** the personal and social responsibilities of living in a diverse world.

Learning Objectives:

1.1 Read canonical texts in the philosophical tradition.
1.2 Analyze, discuss, and critique philosophical texts in class, including through student presentations.
1.3 Analyze and critique philosophical texts in written work, including papers and tests.
2.1 Learn basic philosophical vocabulary, major arguments, and positions in central areas of philosophy.
2.2 Define key concepts in your own words and provide definitions in regular quizzes.
2.3 Demonstrate understanding of key arguments and claims made by philosophers studied in the course through short answer questions and papers.
3. Present logically persuasive arguments in presentations, papers, and tests.
4.1 Engage in critical thinking through classroom discussion and presentations.
4.2 Demonstrate critical thinking skills in written work.
5.1 Consider the impacts of philosophical ideas on personal and social responsibility.
5.2 Apply philosophical concepts discussed in the course to personal and contemporary issues, demonstrating a concern for social and personal responsibility.

Notice About Online Learning Management Software:

This is an online lecture course that uses *Eagle Online*. The *Eagle Online* login page is: https://eagleonline.hccs.edu/

Your Eagle Online username is the same as your HCC e-mail address, which is used for Online Registration (for example: W0034567@student.hccs.edu). Your password is the same password you use to log in to PeopleSoft, HCC Webmail, and Active Directory (computer terminal login). For any questions about your Eagle ID or password, please go check online here.

IMPORTANT: Eagle Online works best with the latest version of Mozilla Firefox. Download it free, here. (Please check your Operating System to see if you have Firefox in your applications.)

Recommended Textbook:

Anthony Weston, *A Rulebook for Arguments: Fourth Edition*, ISBN: 978-0-87220-954-1

PLEASE NOTE: This book is available in both print and ebook formats. It is relatively cheap to purchase and even cheaper to rent. You will be provided with free, open-source copies of all other texts we will read this semester.

Course Calendar:

A complete calendar and schedule of events will be available on Eagle Online. Please check there for the most up-to-date information!

Quizzes:

All quizzes will be given using Eagle Online, HCC's learning management system. The quizzes are due by the date listed on the course schedule, but they may be completed early if students wish. If you have any questions about how to access the quizzes, please ask!

Discussions:

All discussions will consist of written posts to a course forum on Eagle Online, HCC's learning management system. Discussions will follow this format:

1. Students make an original post on the current philosopher and his work (there will be a question prompt for you to answer)
2. Students respond to at least two other students by questioning, explaining, analyzing, evaluating, or expanding upon their postings
3. Students receive half-credit for the assignment by making the original post and half-credit for their two responses to other students
4. **Plagiarism will not be tolerated on discussion posts.** If you do not use your own words, you will be caught and receive a zero for the assignment. Repeated violations of academic dishonesty will result in a zero for the course and a report to HCC administration.

If you have any questions about how to access the course forum, please ask!

Term Paper:

Additional information on the term paper will be made available after students complete a paper preparation exercise. The paper preparation exercise will allow students to practice evaluating the quality of writing and argument that will be required for their own term papers to be successful. There will also be a term paper peer review session where students will read each other's papers and provide each other with constructive criticism on how to improve.

Please note that all papers will be run through Turnitin.com's plagiarism detector.

Grading Policy:

Your grade is based on a weighted average of assignments. The weight and type of each assignment is as follows:

Discussions = 10%
Quizzes = 20%
Term Paper = 30%
Final Exam = 40%

A = 90% to 100%	4 points per semester hour
B = 80% to 89.9%	3 points per semester hour
C = 70% to 79.9%	2 points per semester hour
D = 60% to 69.9%	1 point per semester hour
F = 0% to 59.9%	0 points per semester hour
FX (Failure due to non-attendance)	0 points per semester hour
IP (In Progress)	0 points per semester hour
W (Withdrawn)	0 points per semester hour
I (Incomplete)	0 points per semester hour
AUD (Audit)	0 points per semester hour

IP (In Progress) is given only in certain developmental courses. The student must re-enroll to receive credit. COM (Completed) is given in non-credit and continuing education courses. FINAL GRADE OF FX: Students who stop attending class and do not withdraw themselves prior to the withdrawal deadline may either be dropped by their professor for excessive absences or be assigned the final grade of "FX" at the end of the semester. Students who stop attending classes will receive a grade of "FX", compared to an earned grade of "F" which is due to poor performance. Logging into a DE course without active participation is seen as non-attending. Please note that HCC will not disperse financial aid funding for students who have never attended class.

Students who receive financial aid but fail to attend class will be reported to the Department of Education and may have to pay back their aid. A grade of "FX" is treated exactly the same as a grade of "F" in terms of GPA, probation, suspension, and satisfactory academic progress.
To compute grade point average (GPA), divide the total grade points by the total number of semester hours attempted. The grades "IP," "COM" and "I" do not affect GPA.

Late Policy:

Late work will be accepted on a case-by-case basis. If you know you will be late on an assignment, it is always better to let your instructor know in advance so that arrangements can be made for making up late assignments. Late work will not be accepted after the last day of class, no exceptions!

Academic Dishonesty:

Academic dishonesty will not be tolerated. A student who is academically dishonest is claiming an advantage not available to other students. The instructor is responsible for measuring each student's individual achievements and also for ensuring that all students compete on a level playing field. Thus, in our system, the instructor has teaching, grading, and enforcing roles. You are expected to be familiar with HCC's policy on Academic Dishonesty located here.

Pleading ignorance of the rules, including improper documentation (MLA, APA, etc.) is no justification for academic dishonesty.

Students who plagiarize, collude, or cheat will not have an opportunity to resubmit their work and they will receive a grade of 0 for the first assignment, an F in the course for a second assignment, and a report in our Maxient system which could lead to dismissal from the college.

LockDown Browser + Webcam Requirement:

This course requires the use of LockDown Browser for quizzes and a webcam for the final exam. The webcam can be the type that's built into your computer or one that plugs in with a USB cable. You may also use one of HCC's proctored labs to take the final exam.

If you do so, you will need a password for the final exam: *hegelian*

Watch this brief video to get a basic understanding of LockDown Browser and the webcam feature.

https://www.respondus.com/products/lockdown-browser/student-movie.shtml

Download Instructions
Download and install LockDown Browser from this link:

https://download.respondus.com/lockdown/download.php?id=355612798

Once Installed

- Start LockDown Browser
- Log into to Canvas
- Navigate to the quiz

Note: You won't be able to access a quiz that requires LockDown Browser with a standard web browser. If this is tried, an error message will indicate that the test requires the use of LockDown Browser. Simply start LockDown Browser and navigate back to the exam to continue.

Guidelines

When taking an online quiz, follow these guidelines:

- Ensure you're in a location where you won't be interrupted
- Turn off all other devices (e.g. tablets, phones, second computers) and place them outside of your reach

- Before starting the test, know how much time is available for it, and also that you've allotted sufficient time to complete it
- Clear your desk or workspace of all external materials not permitted - books, papers, other devices
- Remain at your computer for the duration of the test

For the final exam:

- If the computer, Wi-Fi, or location is different than what was used previously with the "Webcam Check" and "System & Network Check" in LockDown Browser, run the checks again prior to the exam
- To produce a good webcam video, do the following:
    - Avoid wearing baseball caps or hats with brims
    - Ensure your computer or device is on a firm surface (a desk or table). Do NOT have the computer on your lap, a bed, or other surface where the device (or you) are likely to move
    - If using a built-in webcam, avoid readjusting the tilt of the screen after the webcam setup is complete
    - Take the exam in a well-lit room, but avoid backlighting (such as sitting with your back to a window)

For both quizzes and the final exam:

- Remember that LockDown Browser will prevent you from accessing other websites or applications; you will be unable to exit the test until all questions are completed and submitted

Getting Help

Several resources are available if you encounter problems with LockDown Browser:

- The Windows and Mac versions of LockDown Browser have a "Help Center" button located on the toolbar. Use the "System & Network Check" to troubleshoot issues. If an exam requires you to use a webcam, also run the "Webcam Check" from this area
- [As applicable, insert information about your institution's help desk, including details about how to contact them. Some help desks want students to run the "System & Network Check" and the "Webcam Check" before they are contacted - and even, to forward the results of these checks at the time of opening a ticket.]
- Respondus has a Knowledge Base available from support.respondus.com. Select the "Knowledge Base" link and then select "Respondus LockDown Browser" as the product. If your problem is with a webcam, select "Respondus Monitor" as your product
- If you're still unable to resolve a technical issue with LockDown Browser, go to support.respondus.com and select "Submit a Ticket". Provide detailed information about your problem and what steps you took to resolve it

Make-Up Policy:

Make-ups are available only with a documented excuse of a serious nature. No late assignments are allowed after the final day of class, no exceptions. See the course schedule for final exam date.

Attendance and Withdrawal Policy:

HCC Students are expected to attend class regularly. A daily record of absences will be maintained throughout the semester. NOTE: It is the responsibility of the student to drop, or officially withdraw from this course. Your instructor will withdraw a student if and only if provided a written request from that student. Additionally, system-wide rules affect withdrawals:

(1) Students who repeat a course for a third, or more times, may face a significant tuition/fee increase at HCC and other Texas public colleges and universities.

(2) The Texas Legislature passed a law limiting new students (those starting college in Fall 2007) to no more than six total course withdrawals throughout their academic career in obtaining a baccalaureate degree. There may be future penalties imposed.

(3) No student may withdraw from a course following the set "last date to withdraw." After that date and time, a student can only be given a grade earned, or an "I" for incomplete. Incompletes must be made up by the end of the following long semester, after which they will automatically change to a grade of "F". Students receiving an "I" for a course are ineligible for graduation until the "I' has been removed from a student's transcript.

Students with Disabilities:

HCC strives to make all learning experiences as accessible as possible. If you anticipate or experience academic barriers based on your disability (including mental health, chronic or temporary medical conditions), please meet with a campus Abilities Counselor as soon as possible in order to establish reasonable accommodations. Reasonable accommodations are established through an interactive process between you, your instructor(s) and Ability Services. It is the policy and practice of HCC to create inclusive and accessible learning environments consistent with federal and state law. For more information, please go to this link. You will find information about the types of assistance offered to students with special instructional needs on that web page. You will also find contact information for your college's ADA compliance and accessibility office.

For questions, please contact Donna Price at (713) 718-5165 or the ADA counselor at your college campus. You can find a list of counselors here.

Title IX of the Education Amendments of 1972, 20 U.S.C. A§ 1681 ET. SEQ:

Title IX of the Education Amendments of 1972 requires that institutions have policies and procedures that protect students' rights with regard to sex/gender discrimination. Information regarding these rights are on the HCC website under Students-Anti-discrimination. Students who are pregnant and require accommodations should contact any of the ADA Counselors for assistance.

It is important that every student understands and conforms to respectful behavior while at HCC. Sexual misconduct is not condoned and will be addressed promptly. Know your rights and how to avoid these difficult situations.

Houston Community College is committed to cultivating an environment free from inappropriate conduct of a sexual or gender-based nature including sex discrimination, sexual assault, sexual harassment, and sexual violence. Sex discrimination includes all forms of sexual and gender-based misconduct and violates an individual's fundamental rights and personal dignity. Title IX prohibits discrimination on the basis of sex-including pregnancy and parental status-in educational programs and activities. If you require an accommodation due to pregnancy please contact an Abilities Services Counselor. The Director of EEO/Compliance is designated as the Title IX Coordinator and Section 504 Coordinator. All inquiries concerning HCC policies, compliance with applicable laws, statutes, and regulations (such as Title VI, Title IX, and Section 504), and complaints may be directed to:

David Cross - Director EEO/Compliance - Office of Institutional Equity & Diversity
3100 Main - Houston, TX 77266-7517 or Institutional.Equity@hccs.edu (713) 718-8271

EGLS3 – Evaluation for Greater Learning Student Survey System:

At Houston Community College, professors believe that thoughtful student feedback is necessary to improve teaching and learning. During a designated time near the end of the term, you will be asked to answer a short online survey of research-based questions related to instruction. The anonymous results of the survey will be made available to your professors and department chairs for continual improvement of instruction. Look for the survey as part of the Houston Community College Student System online near the end of the term.

Here is the link to the MyEagle login page where you can access the EGLS3 survey when the time comes.

Campus Carry Policy:

At HCC the safety of our students, staff, and faculty is our first priority. As of August 1, 2017, Houston Community College is subject to the Campus Carry Law (SB11 2015). For more information, visit the HCC Campus Carry web page here.

Student Support:

Any student who faces challenges securing their food or housing and believes this may affect their performance in the course is urged to contact the Dean of Students for support. Furthermore, please notify the professor if you are comfortable in doing so. This will enable us to provide any resources that HCC may possess.